

MAGWest Safety & Security Information

SAFETY RECOMMENDATIONS:

- Know your location within the venue, both the function space name (what the hotel calls it) and the event space name (what we call it).
- Familiarize yourself with marked exits, fire extinguishers, first aid kits, and AEDs located in your function space, as well as posted evacuation route maps. Not all exits are evacuation exits; know which ones to point out to attendees in the event of an evacuation.
- Proactive reporting can prevent a crisis from occurring. If you see something, say something.
- Help yourself before helping others. Do not risk your own safety.

If an emergency impacts the entire event (e.g. fire, shooting) updates will be given via at-channel announcements in **#west-general** in Slack, over **radio channel 1 ("GENERAL")**, and verbally.

Unless responding to immediate danger, avoid giving instructions to other volunteers or attendees until they are relayed from someone above you in the **chain of command** (see right).

If you receive conflicting instructions, default to the order in the list or confirm with the last person who gave instructions that they received an update from someone above them.

HOW TO CONTACT SECURITY:

- **In-Person:** Silicon Valley Room (ballroom side, 2nd floor, across from Variety Stage).
- **Slack:** post in **#west-security**
- **Text/Call:** 1-833-FEST-SEC (1-833-337-8732)
- **Radio:** Channel 1 ("GENERAL")
- **WHEN IN DOUBT, CALL 911.**
FLARE, our volunteer security team, are identifiable by their **orange vests**.
magwest.org/safety-and-security for more info

Major Emergency Chain of Command

- 1 Emergency Personnel (Police, EMS, Fire)
- 2 Venue Staff
- 3 Security Staff (incl. FLARE, security coordinator, & event chairs)
- 4 Department Heads > Staff > Attendees

IF AN ATTENDEE REPORTS A SAFETY ISSUE TO YOU:

- **Listen** first. They may have difficulty explaining what's going on, particularly if they are distressed or impaired.
- **Repeat** what you've heard. Make sure you understand their issue clearly so that you can properly escalate it.
- **Resolve or Report.** If you are able to resolve simple situations yourself, **please do** (e.g. asking someone to turn down their volume). Otherwise, escalate to Security/MoMs for further action.
- In cases of **harassment or assault**, an attendee might need support that you aren't able to provide, and that's okay! If you sense that an issue might require a specialized Report Taker:
 - ◆ Offer them small comforts (water, a seat, the assurance you will stay with them).
 - ◆ Ask them to wait while you locate someone else.
 - ◆ Ask for a "Report Taker" using radio channel 1 ("GENERAL").

IF AN ATTENDEE IS UNCOOPERATIVE:

- Your role is to communicate the Event Rules and procedures as they exist (for more information, visit magwest.org/code-of-conduct). There's no need to debate the usefulness or purpose of a rule; all attendees have already agreed to follow them.
- If you don't feel comfortable interceding directly, **radio Security on channel 1 ("GENERAL")**. If your DH or area doesn't have a radio, try another one nearby, or report in-person in the Silicon Valley room.
- If you do step in, ask another staffer to back you up.
- Lower your volume and relax your body language. Move to a quieter place if possible.
- Ask if they are willing to walk with you (or another staffer) to Security, where FLARE can assist directly or call the MoM (Manager of MAG) on duty.
- **Obtain a name, picture, or detailed description if you can. Do not touch them or take their badge.**

If someone needs to report an incident *after* the event:

- They can email the Safe Committee at safe@magfest.org.
- Reports can also be made via our online form, available at magwest.org/safety-and-security. Reports can be made anonymously.